ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** Lencho	Lencho is the farmer.
2	**(b)** stamp	He stuck a stamp and dropped it in the mail.
3	**(c)** trust	Faith = trust.
4	**(c)** farmer	He grew corn.
5	**(a)** postmaster	He was amiable and fat.
6	**(b)** crops	Add -s.
7	**(b)** valley	His house stood on a hill in a valley.
8	**(d)** touched by Lencho's faith	He laughed first, then became serious.
9	**(c)** wrote	Wrote.
10	**(c)** corn	Ripe corn.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Lencho was a poor farmer (1) who lived in a valley with his family and grew corn (1).	1+1
12	He wrote to God (1) because he trusted that God would help (1).	1+1
13	He got seventy pesos (1), less than the amount asked (1).	1+1
14	He needed rain (1) to make the ripe field perfect for harvest (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	House on a low hill in a valley (1). From the hill the river and the corn field could be seen (1). The corn was ripe with flowers on it (1).	1+1+1
16	He opened it without surprise (1). He counted the money and got angry (1). He wrote another letter to God (1).	1+1+1
17	Crop - plants grown for food (1). Hail - balls of ice that fall in a storm (1). Faith - strong trust (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He wished for rain for his corn (1). Rain did come (1) but with hail that destroyed everything (1).	1+1+1
18	He thanked God for the money (1). He asked for the remaining money (1). He asked that it should not be sent through the post (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Any three correct sentences, one mark each. Example: Rain is needed for crops (1). Lencho kept hope (1). He wrote a letter (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Farmer with a family (1), lives in a valley (1). Loses crop to hail (1). Strong faith (1). Blames the clerks at the end (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Faith gives courage (1). Lencho believed in God (1). Faith made him write the letter (1). Help may come through people (1). Do not lose hope (1).	2+2+1
20	Fat, friendly man (1). Laughs at the letter first (1). Moved by Lencho's faith (1). Collects money (1). Signs the reply as God (1).	2+2+1
	OR: He did not ignore the letter (1). He gave his own money (1). He asked others to help (1). He wrote the reply himself (1). He did not mind being blamed (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lencho *asked for 100 pesos and the postmaster sent 100*; the postmaster could collect only about 70 pesos, which is why Lencho later complains.
- Saying Lencho lost faith in God; his faith in God stays unshaken. He doubts only the **post-office employees**, calling them a 'bunch of crooks'.
- Mixing up the weather images: the raindrops were like *new coins* (a simile), and the hail did more damage than a plague of locusts; do not call both 'hail like coins'.

- Ignoring the **irony** in the ending: the man who trusts God completely is the one who suspects honest people; the postmaster's kindness is exactly what Lencho fails to see.
- Writing that the postmaster ignored the letter; he first laughed, then was moved, and wrote a reply signed **'God'** to keep Lencho's faith alive.
- Spelling slips: *Lencho, postmaster, hailstorm, plague of locusts*; and using 'who' for things (the letter *which*, not who).

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** the postmaster	He signed it 'God'.
2	**(a)** sent	Send - sent - sent.
3	**(c)** rain	A good shower.
4	**(a)** God	To keep Lencho's faith.
5	**(b)** a	'Letter' starts with a consonant sound.
6	**(c)** hail	A strong wind and hail.
7	**(a)** seventy pesos	Less than asked.
8	**(d)** at	Look at.
9	**(c)** salt	White hail lay everywhere.
10	**(b)** counting the money	He thought he had been cheated.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He asked for one hundred pesos (1) to sow the field again (1).	1+1
12	The amount was less than he had asked for (1), so he blamed the clerks (1).	1+1
13	Hailstones fell (1) with a strong wind and covered the field (1).	1+1
14	The postmaster read it (1) and laughed at first (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	That the loss was heavy (1). That nobody must go hungry this year (1). That they still had help from God (1).	1+1+1
16	Farmer who works hard (1). Has strong faith (1). Does not trust people (1).	1+1+1
17	The wind began to blow (1). Hail fell on the corn field (1). It ruined the crop completely (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He wrote the letter to God (1). He put a stamp on it (1). He dropped it in the mailbox (1).	1+1+1
18	He is kind (1). Helpful and cheerful (1). Respects other people's faith (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Have faith in difficult times (1). Be kind to others (1). Do not blame others without reason (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction of Lencho and ripe field (1). Rain then hail ruins crop (1). Letter to God (1). Postmaster's help (1). Lencho's anger (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Starting line on hope (1). Example from Lencho (1). Role in difficult times (1). Personal view (1). Closing line (1).	2+2+1
20	Proper format (1). Name and author (1). Short summary (1). What you liked (1). Close politely (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date and heading (1). What he felt on opening the letter (1). On counting the money (1). Why he is angry (1). What he wishes to do next (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lencho *asked for 100 pesos and the postmaster sent 100*; the postmaster could collect only about 70 pesos, which is why Lencho later complains.
- Saying Lencho lost faith in God; his faith in God stays unshaken. He doubts only the **post-office employees**, calling them a 'bunch of crooks'.
- Mixing up the weather images: the raindrops were like *new coins* (a simile), and the hail did more damage than a plague of locusts; do not call both 'hail like coins'.
- Ignoring the **irony** in the ending: the man who trusts God completely is the one who suspects honest people; the postmaster's kindness is exactly what Lencho fails to see.
- Writing that the postmaster ignored the letter; he first laughed, then was moved, and wrote a reply signed **'God'** to keep Lencho's faith alive.

- Spelling slips: *Lencho, postmaster, hailstorm, plague of locusts*; and using 'who' for things (the letter *which*, not who).

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** hail	Hail names a thing.
2	**(d)** God	He addressed it to God.
3	**(b)** crooks	He believed they stole money.
4	**(a)** faithful	It describes the man.
5	**(a)** sow the field again	To resow and live until harvest.
6	**(d)** mature	Ripe means ready to be harvested.
7	**(c)** a rural area	Farm and village.
8	**(c)** 100 pesos	One hundred pesos.
9	**(a)** build	Destroy x build.
10	**(d)** Mexico	Gregorio Lopez y Fuentes was Mexican.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He called them crooks (1) because he believed they had taken some money (1).	1+1
12	It looked white like salt (1) and no ear of corn was left (1).	1+1
13	He collected money (1) and wrote a reply signed 'God' (1).	1+1
14	Gregorio Lopez y Fuentes (1), from Mexico (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He burst into laughter (1). Then he became serious (1). He was moved by the faith of the writer (1).	1+1+1
16	He writes to God (1). He asks for a fixed sum (1). He is sure of an answer (1).	1+1+1
17	Lencho loses his crop to hail (1). He writes a letter to God asking for money (1). The postmaster sends some, and Lencho complains (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He collected money (1). He wrote a letter (1). He signed it as God (1).	1+1+1
18	The address 'To God' was strange (1). He had never seen such a letter (1). The idea seemed funny to him (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He wants to protect Lencho's faith (1). Lencho would be hurt by the truth (1). So he signs as God (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Lencho had hoped for a rich harvest (1). The hail destroyed all the corn (1). The family would have to starve (1). He felt helpless (1). Only his faith comforted him (1).	2+2+1
	OR: They had not taken money (1). The postmaster had helped him (1). He should have been thankful (1). He did not know the truth (1). So he was not right (1).	2+2+1
20	He decided to help (1). He gave money from his salary (1). Employees and friends gave money (1). Total seventy pesos collected (1). It was less than needed (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Correct format (1). Son asks what will happen (1). Lencho speaks of faith (1). Plans to write (1). Closing line (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lencho *asked for 100 pesos and the postmaster sent 100*; the postmaster could collect only about 70 pesos, which is why Lencho later complains.
- Saying Lencho lost faith in God; his faith in God stays unshaken. He doubts only the **post-office employees**, calling them a 'bunch of crooks'.
- Mixing up the weather images: the raindrops were like *new coins* (a simile), and the hail did more damage than a plague of locusts; do not call both 'hail like coins'.
- Ignoring the **irony** in the ending: the man who trusts God completely is the one who suspects honest people; the postmaster's kindness is exactly what Lencho fails to see.

- Writing that the postmaster ignored the letter; he first laughed, then was moved, and wrote a reply signed **'God'** to keep Lencho's faith alive.
- Spelling slips: *Lencho, postmaster, hailstorm, plague of locusts*; and using 'who' for things (the letter *which*, not who).

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